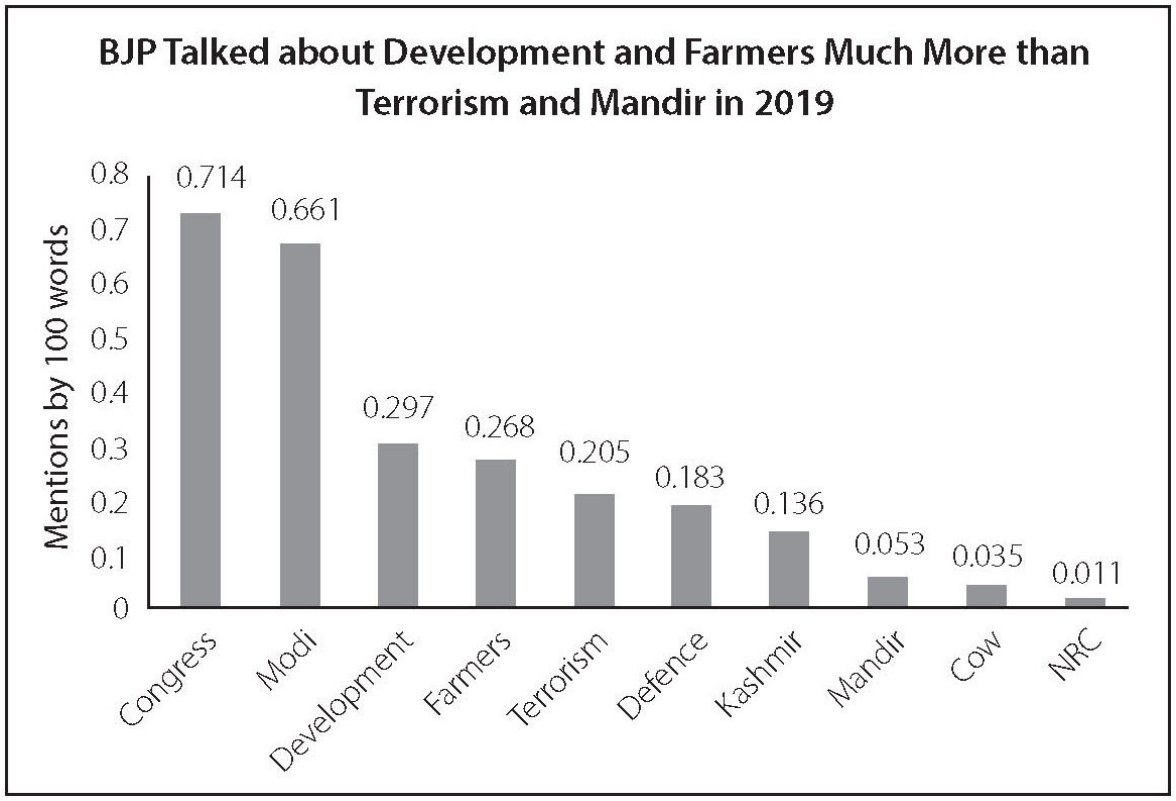
in its public outreach, the BJP speaks far more on these topics than about its core issues—terrorism, the Ram Mandir in Ayodhya or national security.

In its press releases, published articles and speeches by party leaders during 2014–2019, the party's communications focused most on development and on farmers—after the Congress, Modi and the party itself (see Figure 6.7). Part I of this book, on the Hindi heartland, showed how the party politically mobilised the labharthees of DBTs at the booth level. In other words, it sought to mobilise a new rural base, using new strategies and tools of communication to present all the plus points of what Vajpayee propagated as 'India Shining' (the BJP's 2004 slogan), without its negatives. We now have a clear picture of how it communicated this.

**Figure 6.7: BJP Focused on Farmers and Development More than Its Core Ideological Issues**




*Source: Narad Index, Nalin Mehta and Rishabh Srivastava; for more details see Appendix 4/online on [nalinmehta.in](nalinmehta.in)*